

Problem Statement: Strong revenue growth (+9.2%) eroded by structurally elevated input costs (expenditure ratio at 82-88%, capping EBITDA margins at 12.97-17.88%)

Phase 1: Diagnosis

W1

Pull 8-qtr cost data → Heatmap

- UltraTech cost gap: 17%
- JK Lakshmi: Fuel ₹900/t, Power ₹350/t, Logistics ₹1,100/t

W2

Map freight routes → Baseline

- Ambuja rail 40% vs JK 22%
- Ambuja target: 18% cost/tonne cut by FY28

W3

Audit LC3 share → Gap report

- Dalmia 8% fuel savings via LC3
- Dalmia scaled LC3 to 15-20% vs JK's 8%

W4

Consolidate → Sign-off on 2 levers

- Levers: freight routing + LC3 expansion

Phase 2: Pilot

W5

Select pilot lanes → Pilot charter

- Shree hub saves ₹150/tonne
- Success metric: 5-8% cost cut on pilot lanes

W6

Launch pilot + RFPs → Contracts opened

- UltraTech linkage gives 12-15% adv.

W7

Expand LC3 at pilot → Daily tracker

- Target: 5% fuel reduction in 4 wks
- Key risks: clay sourcing, finer grinding

W8

2-wk data → Interim report

- Validates risks before Phase 3 rollout

Phase 3: Scale

W9

Roll out freight → Playbook

- Target: 40% rail
- Standardize routing across all plants

W10

Long-term fuel contracts → Signed

- Target: 12% cost reduction
- UltraTech coal linkages: 12-15% edge

W11

Monsoon protocol → Cost-flex plan

- ACC saved 6% in monsoon via maintenance
- Covers shutdowns, maintenance, logistics, Flexible Staffing

W12

Dashboard → Final readout

- Target: <83% exp ratio vs 87%
- Live alerts if cost growth > revenue growth

DATA NEEDED: Plant-wise P&L | Monthly fuel/power/logistics cost | Peer benchmark (UltraTech, Ambuja, Shree) | 5-yr monsoon data

METRICS: Rev ₹6,762.6Cr (+9.2%) | EBITDA ₹1,011.4Cr | Margin 14.96% | Net Debt/EBITDA 1.12x | Target: 18%+ margin